Proactive Spaces

An insight on the spatial and museographical features of 21st century "post-museum"

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The post-museum is a site of mutuality, where knowledge is not transmitted but rather constructed through the account of multiple subjectivities and identities; where source communities are active participants in museum discourse; where the curator's voice is one voice among many others, that are incorporated to create a constructive polyphony of views, experiences and values; where difficult issues are not hidden, and conflict and contradiction are exposed; where display are eclectic and often dependent of visitors' participation; where the exhibition is only one form of museum communication, enriched with other means to fit with the interpretations of objects and visitors' needs; where agendas, strategies and decision-making processes are continually re-evaluated in order to enhance the museum's contribution in redressing social inequalities and promoting social understanding.

Eilean Hooper-Greenhill, *Museums and the Interpretation of Visual Culture*, 2000



"The Mixing Room" (2010), Te Papa Tongarewa National Museum of New Zealand

Within the permanent exhibition of the museum, a community gallery features regularly changing exhibitions that highlight the contributions made to New Zealand by migrating populations.



“G-town. Wohnzimmer Ginnheim“ (2013), City Lab, Frankfurt City History Museum

A public discussion held in the ‘Kirchplatzgärtchen’, an urban gardening project realised during the Stadtlabor (City Lab) in Ginnheim



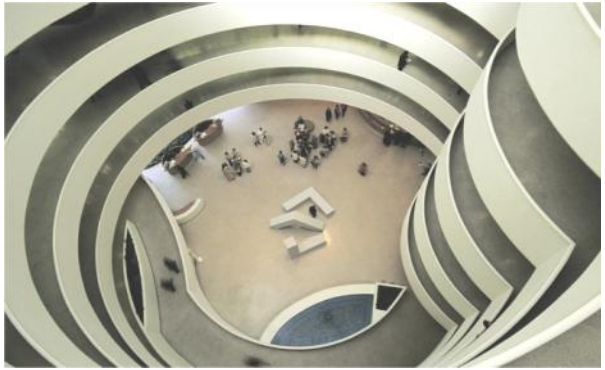
Écomusée du Val de Bièvre, Fresnes, Paris, France

Educative activities in the resource centre, 2005.



“99 x Neukölln” Neukölln, Berlin, Germany
The permanent exhibition “99 x Neukölln,” illustrating the local identity through 99 original objects related to collective and personal memories.








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pro•ac•tive |prōˈaktiv|
adjective
(of a person, policy, or action) creating or controlling a situation by causing something to happen rather than responding to it after it has happened *: be proactive in identifying and preventing potential problems*.

Proactive Spaces are special museum environments conceived to accommodate as well as to foster the development of new activities and curatorial practices.

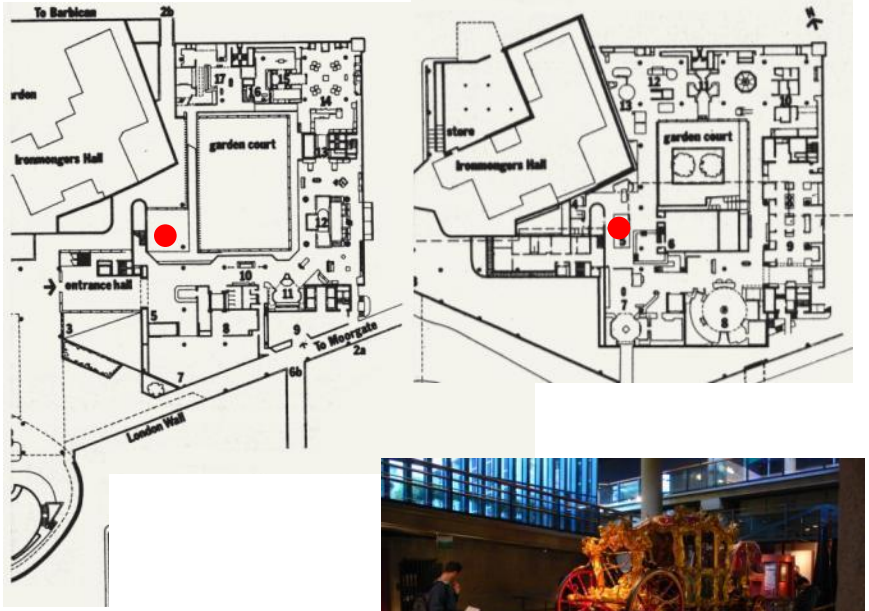
As highlighted by the adjective "pro-active" – pointing out the ability to consciously react to events, and in timely adapt or even drive changes – they are flexible, adaptive, multi-purpose and in-progress spaces, which remain "open" in their form, function and meaning in order to better respond to the evolving requirements of 21st century museums, so far so to support their evolution into "post-museums".







Museum of London, 1976 - 2010


To Barbican
2b
rden
Ironmongers Hall
garden court
entrance hall
London Wall
To Moorgate
2a
store
Ironmongers Hall
garden court




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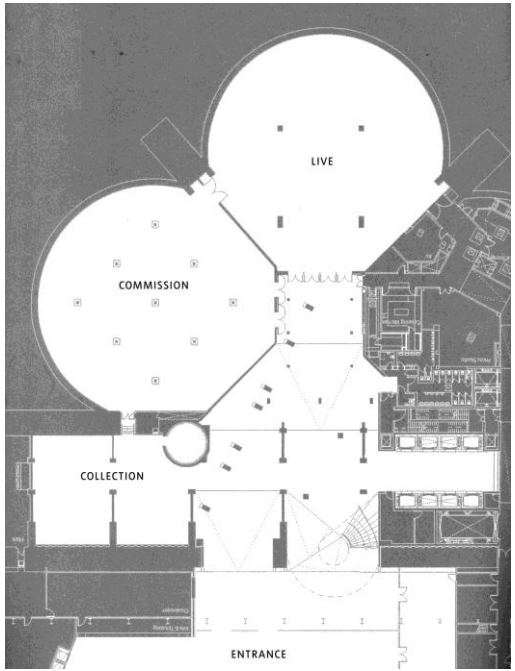




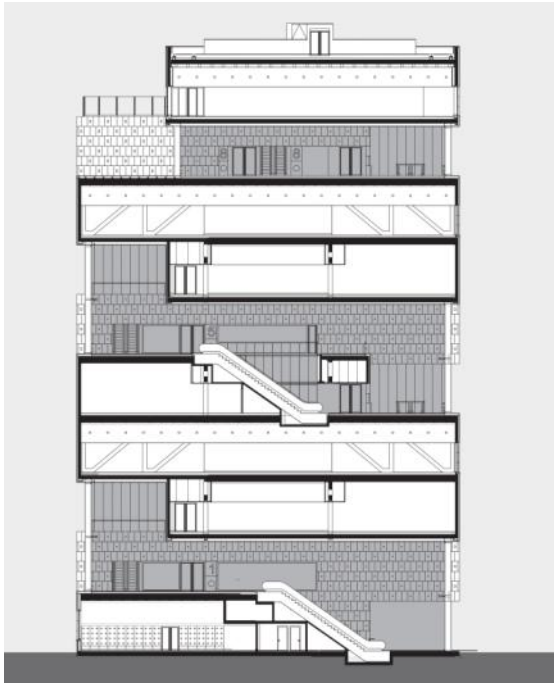


Herzog & De Meuron, The Tanks at Tate Modern, London (2000)

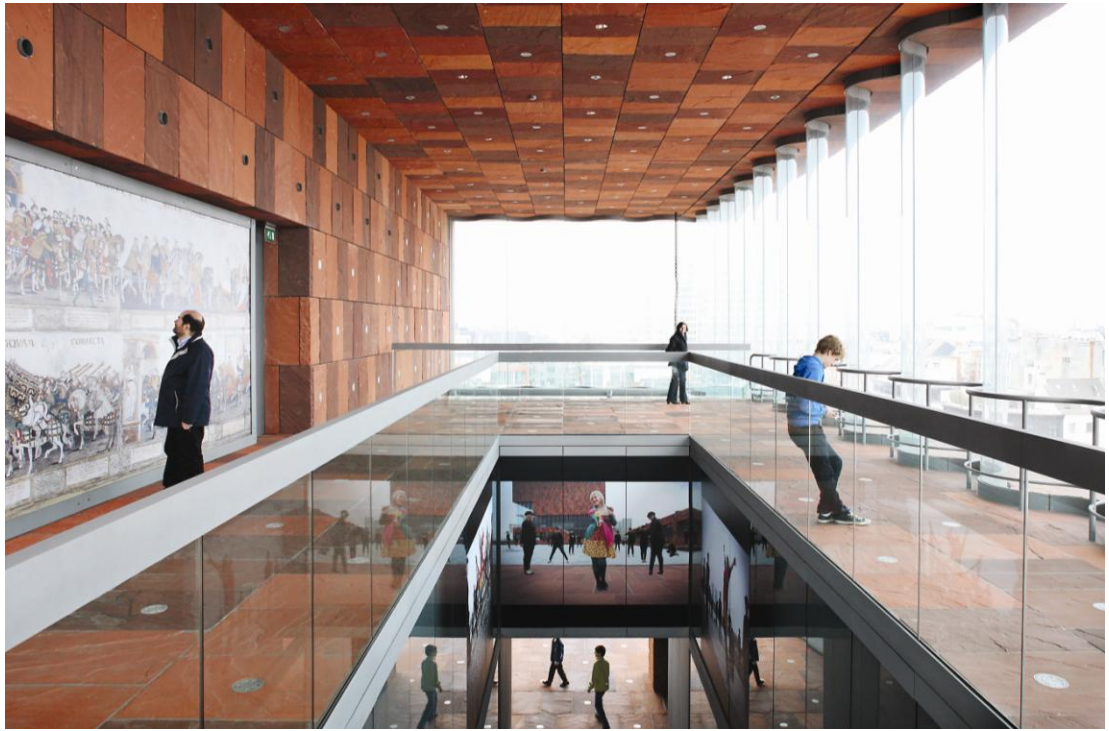

EVENTS FILM


LIVE
COMMISSION
COLLECTION
ENTRANCE





NEUTELINGS RIEDIJK, MAS MUSEUM AAN DE STROOM, ANTWERP, 2011



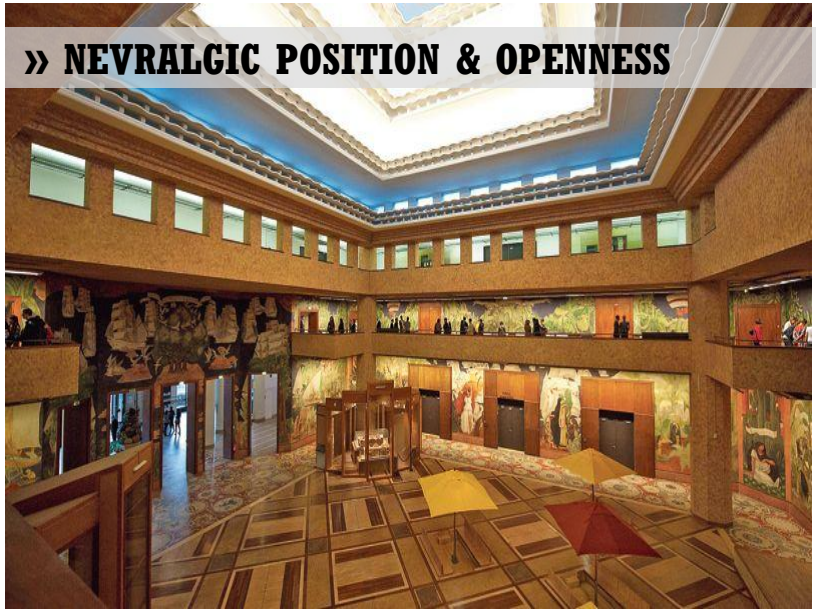




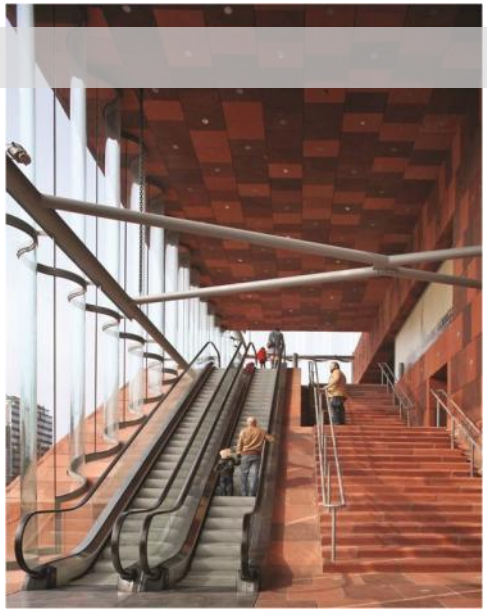
Proactive Spaces | some recurrent formal features

Which are the recurrent architectural features of these spaces? How are the specific requirements of the activities hosted in these spaces reflected in their design?
Which is their location within the museums? How they interact the other museum spaces?
How are they usually set up?

» NEVRALGIC POSITION & OPENNESS

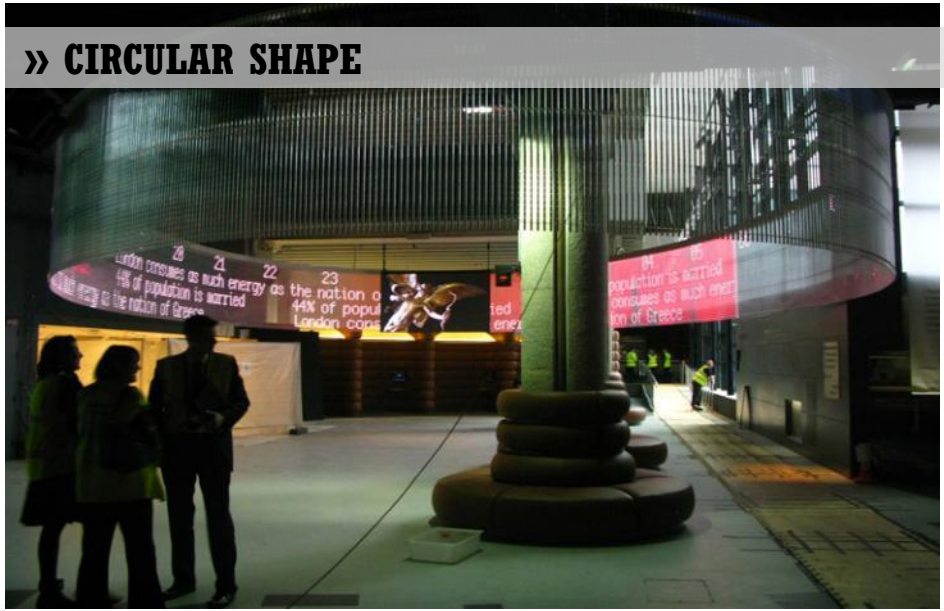


Salle des Fêtes at Musée de l'Histoire de l'immigration, Paris (2007)



The Boulevard at MAS, Antwerp (2011)

» CIRCULAR SHAPE



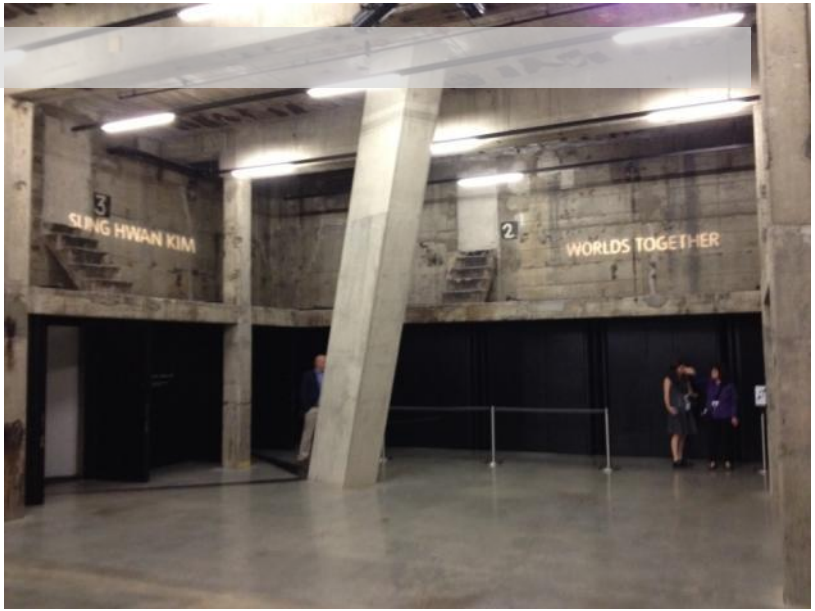
The Sackler Hall at the Museum of London (2010)



The Expanding City Room at STAM Stadtmuseum Gent (1884/2010)

» NON-FINISHED AESTHETICS





White Tunnel at Gallerie Piedicastello, Trento (2007)



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